

Question 28 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the need for integrating HRD practices with organisational strategy.

Answer

Strategy states where the organisation is going; HRD builds the people capability to get there. Integration is therefore a necessity, not a luxury.

- 1. Capability as strategy implementation:** New products, markets, quality or digitalisation fail if people lack competencies.
- 2. Avoiding irrelevant training:** Unintegrated HRD produces popular courses that do not serve business priorities.
- 3. Talent for future structure:** Strategy may need new roles; career and potential systems must prepare them in time.
- 4. Culture required by strategy:** Cost leadership vs innovation need different climates; HRD must shape accordingly.
- 5. Resource efficiency:** Development budgets are limited; strategy tells what to prioritise.
- 6. Change readiness:** Strategic change is mainly a people process; integrated HRD reduces resistance.
- 7. Measurement:** Integration allows HRD to be judged on strategic outcomes, raising its credibility.
- 8. Employee meaning:** People see why they are developed, which increases engagement with HRD practices.

Conclusion. Hence integrating HRD with strategy ensures that development efforts create the right capabilities at the right time for organisational success.